

Fig. 6: A robust secured e-mail flow

which makes a system/individual unavailable to its intended users. Although the means to carry out, motives for, and targets of a DoS attack may vary, it generally consists of the concerted efforts of a person or persons to prevent an Internet site or service from

target (victim) machine with external communication requests, such that it cannot respond to legitimate traffic, or responds so slowly as to be rendered effectively unavailable. In general terms, DoS attacks are implemented by either forcing the targeted computer(s)

functioning efficiently or at all, temporarily or indefinitely. Perpetrators of DoS attacks typically target sites or services hosted on high-profile Web servers such as banks, credit card payment gateways and even root name servers.

One common method of attack involves saturating the

to reset, or consuming its resources so that it can no longer provide its intended service, or obstructing the communication media between the intended users and the victim so that they can no longer communicate adequately. These attacks can be in two ways:

(i) *Exposure of systems to DoS attacks.* E-mail server attached to network may be vulnerable to DoS attacks—more relevant with increasing dependence on e-mail as the communications tool. DoS on mail server may compromise other network services too.

(ii) *Exposure of individuals to denial of service attacks.* Mail bombing, excessive spam generally exposes an individual e-mail client to DoS attack. Individuals get so spammed by incoming e-mail that they stop reading it. We will deal with e-mail spam and e-mail authentication in the next part.

To be concluded next month...

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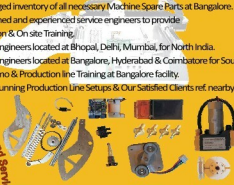
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